

ECON311

Critical Review

Name: Joel Koerner

Topic: Review of “The COVID crisis and productivity growth”

Introduction:

3.5/5

- The overview of the article presented in the introduction is incomplete. The goal of the article is to use a growth accounting framework to discuss the potential long-run effects of the pandemic on measured productivity.

Critical Economic Analysis:

26/30

- **Labour:** This topic was not discussed in your critical review
- **Capital:** This topic was not discussed in your critical review
- **TFP:**
 - *Within-Firm:* Your discussion of within-firm productivity growth is well done. Your citation, which directly updates the prediction of the article regarding firms receiving support to maintain the workforce during the pandemic, adds a lot of value to your review. A topic in the article that you are interpreting incorrectly is the source of intangible inputs loss. In the article, the authors do not consider hiring costs an issue for long-term growth, but the fact that losing workers with lots of firm-specific knowledge results in a loss of intangible assets. Therefore, rehiring the old workers to perform the same task will not lead to a loss of intangible assets. Your discussion of knowledge capital is not clear. On the other hand, your discussion of onshoring and deglobalization in the context of within-firm productivity is very good.
 - *Across-Firm:* Both, your discussions of zombie firms and financial constraints are clear. Again, I think that your discussion of the authors’ prediction citing updated evidence strengthens your review. On the other hand, your discussion of firm selection is not clear
 - *Across-Sectors:* Your discussion of the impact of across sector reallocation does not explain the connection between this channel and the effect of Covid on long-run productivity. Is Health Care a more productivity sector than Tourism? Is this shift permanent

Exposition:

8.5/10

- The critical review is properly organized and for the most part well written.
- There are paragraphs that could have benefited from another round of editing.

Conclusion:

3.5/5

- Your conclusion is incomplete and does not properly summarize your discussion. Also, you introduce the topic of selection on firm size, which is neither discussed in the main analysis section, nor properly explained in the conclusion

Grade: 41.5/50 = 83%